

THE CRAFT OF WRITING FANTASY NARRATIVES



1. WORLDBUILDING

FOUNDATION OF THE FANTASTIC.

- Geography & Environments: Unique landscapes, magical biomes.
- Cultures & Societies: History, politics, beliefs, economies.
- Rules of Reality: Physics, magical laws, limitations.
- Immersion: Details that make the world feel alive.



2. MAGIC SYSTEMS

THE ARCANES ENGINE.

- Source & Origin: Gods, nature, artifacts, inner power.
- Hard vs. Soft Magic: Clearly defined rules vs. mysterious abilities.
- Costs & Limitations: Physical drain, moral price, consequences.
- Integration: How magic affects daily life and society.



3. CHARACTERS

HEROES, VILLAINS & BEYOND.

- Protagonist: Flawed, relatable, with clear motivations.
- Antagonist: Complex, driven, mirror to the hero.
- Archetypes & Tropes: The Chosen One, The Mentor, The Reluctant Hero (used creatively).
- Character Arcs: Growth, transformation, overcoming internal conflict.

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4. PLOT & STRUCTURE

THE EPIC JOURNEY.

- The Hero's Journey: Call to adventure, trials, climax, return.
- Three-Act Structure: Setup, Confrontation, Resolution.
- Key Beats: Inciting Incident, Rising Action, Climax, Falling Action.
- Conflict: Internal & External forces driving the story.



5. TROPES & TWISTS

FAMILIARITY WITH A FRESH SPIN.

- Embrace or Subvert: Use reader expectations creatively.
- Common Tropes: Dark Lord, Ancient Prophecy, Quest for an Artifact.
- Revitalization: Add unique twists, combine tropes, flip perspectives.
- Avoid Clichés: Breathe new life into old ideas.



Narrative Writing Structure

How to build a great story

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4. Climax

The most exciting or important moment in the story.

How does the problem reach its biggest moment?



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3. Rising Action

Show the important events and build suspense.

What happens next?



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2. Complication

A problem begins and the story becomes interesting.

What goes wrong?



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1. Orientation / Beginning

Introduce the characters, setting, and situation.

Who? Where? When?



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5. Resolution / Ending

The problem is solved and the story finishes.

How does it end?



Narrative Writing Tips

- ★ Use interesting characters
- ★ Describe the setting
- ★ Build tension
- ★ Use sequencing words
- ★ End with a satisfying resolution



THE ART OF WRITING SCIENCE FICTION NARRATIVES: A BLUEPRINT FOR SPECULATIVE WORLDS

